

we may account for the phenomena by assuming that it fructified in their minds and helped their thinkers to their solution of the great problem. But the development of the Hebrew Satan is perfectly clear, and wholly different from that of the Magian Ahriman. I have already referred to these differences, and will only now express the belief that a hint was given and used, but used in a wholly original and characteristic way.

A more hopeful field for the discovery of genuine Persian influence lies in Apocalyptic. We have seen that Zarathushtra was really the earliest apocalyptic thinker; and (what is more important for our purpose) he was mostly known to after ages in this character. Now almost the only resemblances that powerfully strike us, by their number and their exactness alike, are found in the imagery of Apocalyptic: not the substance, or the religious ideas that the literature conveys, but the machinery and the formulæ show sometimes a likeness which we cannot easily regard as accidental, the cumulative effect of many coincidences being considered. Several of them affect the Johannine Apocalypse. There is the final unchaining of Aži Dahāka, the Old Serpent, which prepares for his final destruction, and the detail that he swallows the third part of men and beasts:¹ cf. Rev. 20^{2, 7-10}, 8⁷⁻¹², 9¹⁵. Then there is the falling of the great star Gocîhar upon the earth which strongly suggests Rev. 8¹⁰. It may be said, of course, that these are only from the Bundahish, and that there are possibilities of lateness. But, as Prof. Jackson notes, the general antiquity of

¹ Söderblom, *La Vie Future*, p. 258 f. Clemen, *Primitive Christianity*, p. 137 (E.T.).